



Course Outline

ECON 313: Intermediate Macroeconomics (Summer 2026)

Instructor: Sonan Memon

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Housekeeping:

The course runs from July-20-August-16 2026: 3 lectures per week, each lasting for approximately 1 hour, 50 minutes. This is a virtual, asynchronous course, where the recordings will be posted on CANVAS.

All grading and evaluation will also be asynchronous. The assignments will be designed to reduce the influence of AI, and other tactics, such as time constraints on online midterm or final submissions, will be used. However, ultimately, you are responsible for your own learning, and I can only go so far in attempting to disincentivize cheating.

Office Hours: Virtually available upon request by email. If there is student demand, I can hold virtual office hours on ZOOM at a designated time, once every week.

Course GE:

TBA.

Course Learning Objectives and Pedagogical Approach:

This intermediate macroeconomics course is designed for sophomores and juniors. Students will be introduced to macroeconomic modeling through a mathematically rigorous approach. Core models including the Solow, Neoclassical, and New Keynesian models will be covered alongside the analysis of optimal fiscal and monetary policy.

The course adopts a micro-founded framework consistent with the Lucas critique and modern macroeconomic theory. A distinguishing feature of the course is its emphasis on the differences between short-run, medium-run, and long-run analysis, following the approach of [Garlin, 2021](#).

Students will also gain exposure to introductory concepts in empirical macroeconomics: including growth-rate calculations, rolling-window measures, volatility estimation, and

trend-cycle decomposition techniques such as the HP filter and linear trend decomposition.

Course Prerequisites:

EC 202Z; MATH 241 or MATH 251Z; EC 311 is strongly recommended.

Mathematical appendices of [Garlin, 2021](#) should be enough. For further assistance, you may refer to [SimonBlume, 1994](#).

Grading Break up and Policy:

- 4 Assignments (40% of grade and one per week).
- Mid-Term (30% of Grade; Monday, Week 3).
- Final: Last week (30% of grade; August 16th 2026).

Academic Integrity:

You will be reported immediately to the SCCS (The University of Oregon (UO) Office of Student Conduct and Community Standards) if you engage in any cheating, plagiarism or violate academic integrity, as determined by the instructor, in line with university policy.

Textbooks:

- **Main Textbook:** Garin, J., Lester, R., & Sims, E. (2021). Intermediate Macroeconomics. https://juliogarin.com/files/textbook/GLS_Intermediate_Macro.pdf.
- **Reference 1:** Carlin, W., & Soskice, D. W. (2024). Macroeconomics: Institutions, Instability and Inequality. Oxford University Press, USA.
- **Reference 2:** Jones, C. I. (2020). Macroeconomics, 5th edition.
- **Reference 3:** Chugh, Sanjay. (2015). Modern Macroeconomics. MIT Press.

Additional Readings (Not Required):

1. Friedman, M. (1953). The methodology of positive economics. Essays in positive economics, 3(3), 145-178.
2. *Mankiw, N. G. (2006). The macroeconomist as scientist and engineer. Journal of Economic Perspectives, 20(4), 29-46.

3. *Chari, V. V. (1998). Nobel laureate Robert E. Lucas, Jr.: architect of modern macroeconomics. *Journal of Economic Perspectives*, 12(1), 171-186.
4. Lucas, R. E. (1976). Econometric policy evaluation: A critique. In *Carnegie-Rochester conference series on public policy* (Vol. 1, No. 1, pp. 19-46).
5. *Christiano, Lawrence J., Martin S. Eichenbaum, and Mathias Trabandt. 2018. On DSGE Models. *Journal of Economic Perspectives*, 32 (3): 113-40.
6. *Gorton, G. B. (2010). *Slapped by the invisible hand: The panic of 2007*. Oxford University Press.
7. Gennaioli, N., & Shleifer, A. (2020). *A Crisis of Beliefs*. Princeton University Press.
8. Curtin, R. T. (2019). *Consumer expectations: Micro foundations and macro impact*. Cambridge University Press.
9. Reinhart, C. M., & Rogoff, K. S. (2009). *This time is different: Eight centuries of financial folly*. Princeton University Press.
10. Mian, A., & Sufi, A. (2015). *House of debt: How they (and you) caused the Great Recession, and how we can prevent it from happening again*. University of Chicago Press.
11. *Kuttner, K. N. (2018). Outside the box: Unconventional monetary policy in the great recession and beyond. *Journal of Economic Perspectives*, 32(4), 121-46.
12. Caballero, R. J., Farhi, E., & Gourinchas, P. O. (2017). The safe assets shortage conundrum. *Journal of Economic Perspectives*, 31(3), 29-46.
13. *Admati, A. R., & Hellwig, M. F. (2019). *Bank Leverage, Welfare, and Regulation*. Rock Center for Corporate Governance at Stanford University Working Paper, (235).
14. *Admati, A. R. (2016). Rethinking Financial Regulation: How confusion has prevented progress. *Progress and Confusion: The State of Macroeconomic Policy*, 61.
15. *Bank for International Settlements. (2011). *Basel III: a global regulatory framework for more resilient banks and banking systems*. BIS. <https://www.bis.org/>.

Outline of Lectures

1. **Introduction (Lec 1):** Course Overview, Philosophy of Macroeconomics and History of Macroeconomic Thought (chapters 2-3 from [Garlin, 2021](#)).
2. **Macroeconomic Data (Lec 2):** Defining Macroeconomic Data (chapter 1 [Garlin, 2021](#)).
3. **The Long Run (Lec 3-4):** Stylized Facts about Economic Growth, Understanding Cross-Country Income Differences and Solow Model (chapters 4, 5 and 7 from [Garlin, 2021](#)).
4. **The Microeconomics of Macroeconomics (Lec 5-6):** Dynamic Consumption Saving Decisions and Production, Labor Demand, Investment, Labor Supply and Monopolistic Competition (chapters 9, 10, 12 and 16 from [Garlin, 2021](#)).
5. **Business Cycles (Lec 7-12):** Neo-classical and New Keynesian Model (chapters 18-21 and 24 to 27 from [Garlin, 2021](#)).